

“Linux has a strong ecosystem of development platforms, server components and applications that are very enticing to Web developers and site owners.”

Flavio Andrade, Web hosting manager, Go Daddy



“... In the last few years, the average end-user has started to understand the concept better, and there have been technological advancements in the virtualisation space that have enabled us to extend the concept to what our customers touch and see. Great improvements have been made in elasticity, scalability and hardware abstraction,” Andrade states. But does this mean that the dedicated server market is shrinking? Andrade doesn't think so. He contends: “More people will realise that to them it's better to have a scalable platform that's fully virtualised than being limited to their own physical server. That doesn't mean the dedicated server market is shrinking, though. Go Daddy sells considerably more dedicated servers today than we did a year ago. However, Go Daddy has seen growth in the virtual and cloud computing fronts as well.”

How does Linux fare in India?

If we turn our focus to India, Linux Web hosting solutions are becoming popular among Indian companies too, because these solutions are relatively cheaper than the proprietary options such as Windows solutions. “Cost is an important factor in the Indian Web hosting industry. The availability of cheap Linux server solutions is helping fuel the growth of Linux in the Indian Web hosting industry. The increasing use of PHP as the scripting language and MySQL as the database software is also increasing the demand for Linux Web hosting in India,” observes Reddy.

Andrade also shares that the number of its Indian customers for virtual dedicated servers is rising by the day. The company has in fact set up a data centre in Asia, especially keeping in view the requirements of customers who want their sites to be physically closer to where their visitors are.

In a nutshell

With the market dynamics changing more rapidly than ever, the rate at which customers are adopting open source related technologies and products has also been on the rise, globally as well as in India. With data

Linux Web hosting solutions: A few options

Web hosting in Linux comes in a wide variety of options, which are referred to as ‘flavours’. There are numerous versions of the Linux OS available, targeting a variety of users or webmasters who may have different skillsets, levels of expertise, preferences, or technological needs. Meanwhile, Windows is usually distributed in just a few versions, each being almost similar to the other.

Reddy enumerates a few options that webmasters can explore, “Some of the Linux-based hosting solutions available in the Indian market are Ubuntu, Kubuntu, Debian, Fedora and CentOS. Linux operating systems allow for an open source environment and the technologies used are highly familiar, such as PHP, XML, SQL and others.”

Go Daddy's 4th Generation Hosting (4GH) is another Web hosting solution. This solution is hosted in a cloud environment with clusters of load-balanced servers that distribute the load across several servers, offering resilience and scalability. A few other Go Daddy solutions include virtual-specific hosting designed for those who want the flexibility of managing their operating system, but don't want the cost of a dedicated server. Another solution comprises dedicated servers for customers who want their own physical servers, and managed hosting which is meant for people who don't want to manage the server themselves.

centres also switching to Linux and open source tools and platforms, the end customer is reaping the benefits of increased efficiencies and lower costs. The overall cost of ownership has also been reduced significantly.

Considering all the advantages that Linux-based Web hosting offers, organisations that adopt these solutions will surely find themselves smiling at their decision at the end of the day! 

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